

Word family: COURT / COURTS / COURTED / COURTING / COURTSHIP / COURTIER / COURTLY / COURTLINESS / COURTROOM / COURTHOUSE / COURTYARD / FORECOURT

Base word: court

Plural noun: courts

Past tense: courted

Past participle: courted

-ing form: courting

Related forms: courtship, courtier, courtly, courtliness, courtroom, courthouse, courtyard, forecourt

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Major useful extensions

court of law, go to court, take someone to court, bring a case before the court, appear in court, court case, court hearing, court proceedings, court trial, court order, court ruling, court judgment, court decision, court action, court costs, court record, court system, court-appointed, court-ordered, higher court, lower court, trial court, appellate court, court of appeal, supreme court, civil court, criminal court, family court, juvenile court, small claims court, magistrates' court, military court, court-martial, moot court, courtroom, courthouse, out-of-court settlement, contempt of court, court of public opinion, royal court, court life, courtier, courtly, hold court, sports court, tennis court, basketball court, badminton court, volleyball court, squash court, pickleball court, court sport, home court, full court, half court, on court, off court, court surface, court shoes, food court, courtyard, forecourt, court as a street/place-name element, court someone romantically, court someone's favour, court customers/investors, court attention/publicity, court support/approval, court danger, court disaster, court trouble, court controversy, courtship, animal courtship, courtship display.

A. PASSAGE SENSE — A PLACE / PROCESS OF FORMAL JUDGMENT

1. court = place or institution where people are formally judged under law — 法庭; 法院

Passage anchor

“How could the teacher protect the victim without turning the classroom into a **court**?”

Meaning

Here, **court** is figurative.

The writer does not mean that the classroom literally becomes a legal court.

It means:

the classroom becomes like a place where someone is accused, judged, questioned, and punished in an overly formal or adversarial way

像法庭般審問／審判人的地方

Practice 1

The teacher wanted to deal with the problem without turning the discussion into a **court**.

老師希望處理問題，但又不想把討論變成像法庭審判一樣。

Practice 2

A classroom should not become a **courtroom** where every mistake is treated like a crime.

課室不應變成一個把每個錯誤都當成罪行審理的法庭。

B. COURT — LEGAL INSTITUTION

2. court = institution with legal authority to hear and decide cases — 法院; 法庭

Practice

1. The case will be heard in **court**.
案件將在法院審理。
2. The **court** rejected the application.
法院駁回了申請。

This is the central legal sense.

C. COURT OF LAW

3. court of law

= official legal institution in which cases are decided
法院; 法庭

Practice

1. The dispute eventually reached a **court of law**.
爭議最終進入司法程序／法院。

Often used to emphasize literal legal proceedings.

D. COURT — THE JUDGE / JUDICIAL BODY

4. the court = judge or judges acting in their judicial capacity — 法庭; 法官／合議庭

Practice

1. **The court ruled** that the evidence was admissible.
法庭裁定該證據可被接納。
2. **The court ordered** a new hearing.
法院下令重新聆訊。

Here **court** does not mean the building; it means the judicial authority.

E. COURT — PHYSICAL ROOM

5. court = courtroom / room where proceedings take place — 法庭; 審訊室

Practice

1. Everyone stood as the judge entered the **court**.
法官進入法庭時, 所有人都站起來。

In everyday English, **courtroom** is often clearer for the physical room.

F. COURTROOM

6. courtroom

= room in which a court hearing or trial takes place
法庭; 法庭審訊室

Practice

1. The witness entered the **courtroom**.
證人進入法庭。
-

G. COURTHOUSE

7. courthouse

= building containing one or more courts/courtrooms

法院大樓; 法庭大樓

Practice

1. Reporters waited outside the **courthouse**.

記者在法院大樓外等候。

Very important distinction:

courtroom

→ 一個審訊房間

courthouse

→ 整座法院建築

H. GO TO COURT

8. go to court

= use legal proceedings to resolve a dispute / appear in legal proceedings

上法院; 訴諸法律

Practice

1. They decided to **go to court**.

他們決定訴諸法律／上法院。

This does not merely mean physically visiting a courthouse.

I. TAKE SOMEONE TO COURT

9. take someone to court

= begin legal proceedings against someone
控告某人;把某人告上法庭

Practice

1. The customer threatened to **take the company to court**.
顧客威脅要把公司告上法庭。

J. BRING A CASE BEFORE THE COURT

10. bring a case before the court

= formally place a legal case before a court for decision
把案件提交法院審理

Formal legal construction.

K. APPEAR IN COURT

11. appear in court

= attend court formally as a party, witness, accused person, lawyer, etc.
出庭

Practice

1. He was required to **appear in court**.
他被要求出庭。

L. BE IN COURT

12. be in court

= be attending / involved in court proceedings
正在出庭; 在法庭上

Practice

1. Her lawyer is **in court** this morning.
她的律師今早正在出庭。
-

M. COURT CASE

13. court case

= dispute or prosecution being dealt with by a court
法院案件; 訴訟案件

Practice

1. The dispute became a **court case**.
爭議演變成一宗訴訟案件。
-

N. COURT HEARING

14. court hearing

= formal session at which a court hears arguments/evidence on a matter
法庭聆訊; 庭審

Practice

1. A **court hearing** is scheduled for next month.
下月安排了一次法庭聆訊。
-

O. COURT PROCEEDINGS

15. court proceedings

= formal legal processes conducted in court
法院程序; 訴訟程序

Practice

1. Details emerged during **court proceedings**.
詳情在法庭程序中披露。
-

P. COURT TRIAL

16. trial / court trial

= formal judicial examination of a case
審訊; 審判

Normally simply **trial** is sufficient.

Q. COURT ORDER

17. court order

= legally binding direction issued by a court
法院命令; 法庭命令

Practice

1. The company complied with the **court order**.
公司遵從了法院命令。
-

R. COURT-ORDERED

18. court-ordered

= required by a court
法院命令的 ; 由法院下令的

Examples:

- court-ordered payment
 - court-ordered treatment
 - court-ordered disclosure
-

S. COURT RULING

19. court ruling

= formal decision on a legal issue by a court
法院裁決 ; 法庭裁定

T. COURT DECISION

20. court decision

= decision made by a court
法院決定 / 判決

Broader and less technically specific than some legal terms such as **judgment** or **ruling**.

U. COURT JUDGMENT / JUDGEMENT

21. court judgment / judgement

= formal judicial decision, especially explaining the result/reasons

法院判決; 判詞

Spelling:

- **judgment** common generally and standard in much legal English
 - **judgement** also common in British general English
-

V. COURT ACTION

22. court action

= legal proceedings taken through a court

法律行動; 訴訟

Practice

1. They threatened **court action**.
他們威脅採取法律行動。
-

W. COURT COSTS

23. court costs

= legal costs/fees associated with court proceedings

訴訟費用; 法庭費用

X. COURT FEES

24. court fees

= fees charged for filing or conducting matters through a court system
法院費用; 法庭費用

Y. COURT RECORD

25. court record

= official record/document relating to court proceedings
法庭紀錄; 法院紀錄

Z. COURT DOCUMENTS / PAPERS

26. court documents / court papers

= formal documents filed with or issued by a court
法院文件; 訴訟文件

AA. COURT SYSTEM

27. court system

= organized network/hierarchy of courts in a jurisdiction
法院制度; 司法法院體系

AB. LOWER COURT

28. lower court

= court below another court in a judicial hierarchy
下級法院

AC. HIGHER COURT

29. higher court

= court above another court in the hierarchy
上級法院

AD. TRIAL COURT

30. trial court

= court in which cases are initially tried and evidence is heard
審判法院; 一審法院

Terminology varies by legal system.

AE. APPELLATE COURT

31. appellate court

= court reviewing decisions of lower courts
上訴法院

AF. COURT OF APPEAL / APPEALS COURT

32. court of appeal / appeals court

= court hearing appeals against lower-court decisions
上訴法院

Exact title varies by jurisdiction.

AG. SUPREME / HIGHEST COURT

33. supreme court / highest court

= court at or near the highest level of a judicial system
最高法院

Capitalization depends on whether it is part of an official institutional name.

AH. HIGH COURT

34. High Court / high court

= name/category of superior court in some jurisdictions
高等法院

The exact powers differ by legal system.

AI. DISTRICT COURT

35. district court

= court serving a defined district; exact jurisdiction varies
地區法院／地方法院

AJ. CIRCUIT COURT

36. circuit court

= type of court used in some jurisdictions
巡迴法院／巡迴法庭

Legal powers vary by system.

AK. CIVIL COURT

37. civil court

= court dealing with non-criminal disputes
民事法院

AL. CRIMINAL COURT

38. criminal court

= court dealing with criminal charges
刑事法院

AM. FAMILY COURT

39. family court

= court dealing with family-law matters
家事法庭; 家庭法院

AN. JUVENILE COURT

40. juvenile court

= court dealing with cases involving minors under a particular legal system
少年法庭

Exact age/jurisdiction rules vary.

AO. SMALL CLAIMS COURT

41. small claims court

= court/process designed for relatively low-value civil claims, usually with simplified procedures
小額錢債／小額索償法庭

Exact limits vary by jurisdiction.

AP. MAGISTRATES' COURT

42. magistrates' court

Especially England and Wales and some related systems:

= lower court dealing with specified criminal/civil matters
裁判法院／治安法院

Jurisdiction-specific term.

AQ. CROWN COURT

43. Crown Court

England and Wales:

= court dealing principally with more serious criminal matters and certain appeals
皇室法院

Jurisdiction-specific proper term.

AR. PROBATE COURT

44. probate court

= court dealing with wills, estates, and related matters in some jurisdictions
遺囑認證法院；遺產法院

AS. BANKRUPTCY COURT

45. bankruptcy court

= court dealing with bankruptcy matters in systems that have such courts
破產法院

AT. TAX COURT

46. tax court

= specialized court/tribunal dealing with tax disputes in some jurisdictions

稅務法院

AU. TRAFFIC COURT

47. traffic court

= court dealing with traffic-law violations in some jurisdictions

交通法庭

AV. MILITARY COURT

48. military court

= court dealing with military law/offences

軍事法庭

AW. COURT-MARTIAL — NOUN

49. court-martial

= military court convened to try alleged military offences

軍事法庭; 軍法審判

Plural traditionally:

AX. COURT-MARTIAL — VERB

50. court-martial someone

= subject a member of the armed forces to trial by court-martial
把某人交軍事法庭審判

Past:

court-martialed / court-martialled

AY. MOOT COURT

51. moot court

Legal education:

= simulated court proceedings in which students practise legal argument
模擬法庭

Practice

1. Law students took part in a **moot court** competition.
法律學生參加了模擬法庭比賽。
-

AZ. COURT-APPOINTED

52. court-appointed

= officially appointed by a court
由法院委任的

Examples:

- court-appointed lawyer
 - court-appointed expert
 - court-appointed guardian
-

BA. OUT OF COURT

53. out of court

= without completing a dispute through a court trial
庭外; 不經法庭審訊

Most common in:

settle out of court

BB. OUT-OF-COURT SETTLEMENT

54. out-of-court settlement

= agreement resolving a legal dispute without final adjudication in court
庭外和解

Practice

1. The parties reached an **out-of-court settlement**.
雙方達成了庭外和解。
-

BC. SETTLE OUT OF COURT

55. settle out of court

= resolve a legal dispute by agreement rather than trial
庭外和解

BD. CONTEMPT OF COURT

56. contempt of court

= conduct that disobeys, obstructs, or seriously disrespects the authority/process of a court, as legally defined
藐視法庭

Established legal term.

BE. IN CAMERA / CLOSED COURT — RELATED LEGAL CONCEPT

57. closed court / closed hearing

= proceedings not open to the general public
閉門聆訊; 非公開法庭程序

Not a new sense of *court*, but useful legal construction.

BF. OPEN COURT

58. open court

= court proceedings conducted publicly
公開法庭; 公開審訊

BG. COURT OF PUBLIC OPINION

59. court of public opinion

= figurative process in which the public collectively judges a person, organization, event, etc.
輿論法庭; 公眾輿論的審判

Practice

1. The issue was being tried in the **court of public opinion**.
這件事正在輿論法庭中被評判。

Very high-value figurative expression.

It is not a real legal court.

BH. TRIAL BY MEDIA — RELATED FIGURATIVE IDEA

60. trial by media

= situation in which media/public coverage appears to judge a person before or outside formal legal proceedings
媒體審判

Related to **court of public opinion**, but not part of the *court* family itself.

BI. COURT = ROYAL HOUSEHOLD / MONARCH'S CIRCLE

61. court = monarch and people surrounding them — 宮廷 ; 朝廷

Practice

1. Artists gathered at the royal **court**.
藝術家聚集在皇家宮廷。
2. He became influential at **court**.
他在朝廷／宮廷中變得很有影響力。

Major historical/cultural sense.

BJ. ROYAL COURT

62. royal court

= monarch together with household, advisers, attendants, nobles, etc.
皇家宮廷; 朝廷

BK. COURT = PLACE WHERE MONARCH RESIDES / RECEIVES PEOPLE

63. court

Historical:

= place/environment associated with a monarch's household and official social life
宮廷

Example

She was presented at **court**.

她獲正式引見至宮廷。

Historical/formal.

BL. COURT LIFE

64. court life

= social/political/cultural life surrounding a royal household
宮廷生活

BM. COURT POLITICS

65. court politics

Historical:

= rivalries, alliances, influence, etc. within a royal court
宮廷政治; 朝廷內部權力關係

Historical analytical term.

BN. COURTIER

66. courtier

= person who attends or serves at a royal court, especially someone seeking/holding influence there
廷臣; 宮廷侍臣

Practice

1. The king was surrounded by **courtiers**.
國王身邊有許多廷臣。

BO. COURTLY

67. courtly

A. relating to a royal court

宮廷的

B. extremely polite, refined, or ceremonious in a traditional way

彬彬有禮的; 典雅有禮的

Practice

1. He greeted her with **courtly manners**.
他以十分典雅有禮的方式向她問好。

BP. COURTLINESS

68. courtliness

= refined, ceremonious politeness associated with courtly behavior
彬彬有禮; 宮廷式禮儀

Lower-frequency noun.

BQ. COURTLY LOVE

69. courtly love

Literary/history term:

= medieval literary tradition/convention of idealized, often highly formalized romantic devotion
宮廷愛情; 騎士式愛情

Established cultural term.

BR. HOLD COURT — ROYAL ORIGIN

70. hold court

A. monarch formally receives people / conducts court business

舉行朝會; 接受謁見

B. figuratively, be the center of attention while speaking to a group

成為眾人焦點; 高談闊論吸引眾人

Practice

1. He was **holding court** in the corner of the room.
他在房間一角被一群人圍著高談闊論。

Very useful idiom.

BS. PAY COURT TO SOMEONE

71. pay court to someone

Formal/old-fashioned:

= seek someone's favour or romantic attention
向某人獻殷勤; 討好某人

Historical/literary, but established.

BT. COURT — SPORTS PLAYING AREA

72. court = marked playing area for certain sports — 球場；場地

Practice

1. The players walked onto the **court**.
球員走上球場。
2. The ball landed outside the **court**.
球落在場地之外。

Major modern sense.

BU. TENNIS COURT

73. tennis court

= marked surface on which tennis is played
網球場

BV. BASKETBALL COURT

74. basketball court

= marked playing area for basketball
籃球場

BW. BADMINTON COURT

75. badminton court

羽毛球場

BX. VOLLEYBALL COURT

76. volleyball court

排球場

BY. SQUASH COURT

77. squash court

= enclosed playing area for squash
壁球場

BZ. PICKLEBALL COURT

78. pickleball court

匹克球場

CA. NETBALL COURT

79. netball court

投球／籃網球場

Regional sport term.

CB. COURT SPORT

80. court sport

= sport played on a defined court

場地球類運動

Examples include tennis, basketball, badminton, squash, etc.

CC. ON COURT

81. on court

= on the playing court / while playing

在球場上

Practice

1. She is very calm **on court**.
她在球場上非常冷靜。
-

CD. OFF COURT

82. off court

= away from actual play / outside the sporting court context

場外；不在比賽時

Practice

1. They are friends **off court**.
他們在場外是朋友。
-

CE. HOME COURT

83. home court

= team/player's usual home playing court
主場

Practice

1. The team has **home-court advantage**.
球隊擁有主場優勢。
-

CF. HOME-COURT ADVANTAGE

84. home-court advantage

= advantage associated with playing at one's home venue
主場優勢

Especially basketball and other court sports.

CG. FULL COURT

85. full court

= entire playing court
全場

Example:

full-court practice
全場練習

CH. HALF COURT

86. half court

= one half of a sports court
半場

CI. FULL-COURT PRESS

87. full-court press

Basketball:

= defensive strategy applying pressure across the whole court
全場緊迫防守

Figuratively, especially AmE:

= intense, comprehensive effort to persuade or achieve something
全面施壓; 全力推進

Example

The company launched a **full-court press** to win the account.

公司展開全力攻勢爭取該客戶。

High-value figurative sports extension.

CJ. COURT SURFACE

88. court surface

= material/type of playing surface
球場地地面 ; 場地表面

Examples:

- clay
 - grass
 - hard court
-

CK. HARD COURT

89. hard court

= sports court with a hard synthetic/concrete/asphalt-type surface, especially tennis
硬地球場

CL. CLAY COURT

90. clay court

泥地網球場

CM. GRASS COURT

91. grass court

草地網球場

CN. COURT SHOES — SPORTS

92. court shoes

= shoes designed for sports played on courts

場地運動鞋; 球場鞋

Context may specify tennis, basketball, etc.

CO. COURT SHOE — BrE WOMEN'S FOOTWEAR

93. court shoe

British English:

= low-cut women's formal shoe, usually without fastening; roughly AmE **pump**

女裝淺口鞋; 高跟淺口鞋

This is a completely different lexicalized compound from sports **court shoes**.

CP. FOOD COURT

94. food court

= area, especially in a shopping center, containing multiple food outlets with shared seating

美食廣場; 食肆集中區

Practice

1. We met in the mall's **food court**.
我們在商場的美食廣場見面。

Major modern compound.

CQ. COURTYARD

95. courtyard

= open area enclosed or partly enclosed by buildings/walls
庭院；內院

Practice

1. Students gathered in the **courtyard**.
學生聚集在庭院。

Important family compound.

CR. COURT — ENCLOSED YARD / QUADRANGLE

96. court

Less common/architectural:

= enclosed or partly enclosed open space surrounded by buildings
庭院；內院

Example

The rooms looked onto an inner **court**.

房間面向一個內部庭院。

The compound **courtyard** is much more common in everyday English.

CS. UNIVERSITY / COLLEGE COURT

97. court

In some older institutional/building contexts:

= quadrangle or enclosed courtyard within a college, palace, etc.

方庭；院子

Often occurs in proper place names.

CT. FORECOURT

98. forecourt

= open area in front of a building

前院；前庭

In BrE especially:

petrol-station forecourt

加油站前方／油泵區

CU. SERVICE-STATION / PETROL-STATION FORECOURT

99. forecourt

= open paved area around fuel pumps at a filling station

加油站油泵區；前場

Established BrE usage.

CV. COURT — STREET / PLACE-NAME ELEMENT

100. Court

In street/place names:

= often a short street, enclosed development, cul-de-sac, courtyard complex, etc.

短街／盡頭路／院落式住宅區名稱元素

Example:

Oak Court

The exact physical form varies by locality.

Often abbreviated in addresses as **Ct.** in North America.

CW. COURT — GROUP OF BUILDINGS AROUND A YARD

101. court

Historical/architectural:

= group of buildings arranged around a courtyard

院落式建築群

Lower priority but established.

CX. VERB — COURT SOMEONE ROMANTICALLY

102. court someone

= try to gain someone's romantic affection, traditionally with marriage in mind
追求某人；向某人求愛

Practice

1. He **courted her** for several years.
他追求她多年。
2. The novel tells the story of a young man **courting** his neighbour.
小說講述一名年輕男子追求鄰居女子的故事。

This is more formal/old-fashioned than **date** in many modern contexts.

CY. COURT — BE IN A ROMANTIC COURTSHIP

103. court

Intransitive, traditional:

= spend time together as romantic partners before marriage
談戀愛；求愛交往

Practice

1. They **courted** for two years before marrying.
他們婚前交往／相戀兩年。

Old-fashioned/traditional register.

CZ. COURTSHIP — ROMANTIC

104. courtship

= period/process in which people develop a romantic relationship, traditionally before marriage
求愛; 戀愛追求期

Practice

1. Their **courtship** lasted several years.
他們的戀愛追求期持續了數年。
-

DA. COURTSHIP — ANIMAL BEHAVIOR

105. courtship

Biology/zoology:

= behavior animals use to attract/select mates before mating
求偶行為

Practice

1. The birds begin their **courtship** in spring.
這些鳥會在春天開始求偶。

Major biological extension.

DB. COURTSHIP DISPLAY

106. courtship display

= display/behavior used by an animal to attract a mate
求偶展示; 求偶炫示

Practice

1. The male performs an elaborate **courtship display**.
雄性會進行複雜的求偶展示。
-

DC. COURT = SEEK SOMEONE'S FAVOUR

107. court someone's favour / favor

= deliberately try to gain someone's approval, goodwill, or support
討好；爭取某人的好感／支持

Practice

1. The company tried to **court investors' favour**.
公司試圖爭取投資者的好感。

This develops naturally from romantic wooing.

DD. COURT APPROVAL

108. court approval

As a **verb + object**:

court approval

= actively seek approval
爭取認同／批准

Practice

1. The designer deliberately **courted approval** from critics.
設計師刻意爭取評論界的認同。

Do not confuse with the noun phrase:

court approval

in legal contexts, which can mean 法院批准.

Context and grammar decide.

DE. COURT SUPPORT

109. court support

As a verb:

= actively seek support
爭取支持

Practice

1. The organization is **courting support** from local businesses.
該機構正在爭取本地企業支持。
-

DF. COURT CUSTOMERS / CLIENTS

110. court customers / clients

= try actively to attract their business
招攬／爭取顧客

Practice

1. Retailers are **courting younger customers**.
零售商正在積極招攬年輕顧客。

Major business figurative sense.

DG. COURT INVESTORS

111. court investors

= try to attract investment / investor support
爭取投資者; 吸引投資

Practice

1. The company is **courting new investors**.
公司正積極吸引新的投資者。
-

DH. COURT BUYERS

112. court buyers

= actively seek to attract potential purchasers
爭取買家

DI. COURT BUSINESS

113. court business

= actively seek commercial business/contracts/customers
招攬生意

Practice

1. The firm is **courting business** overseas.
公司正在海外招攬生意。
-

DJ. COURT ATTENTION

114. court attention

= deliberately seek or invite attention
刻意吸引注意

Practice

1. He dislikes **courting attention**.
他不喜歡刻意引人注目。
-

DK. COURT PUBLICITY

115. court publicity

= deliberately seek media/public attention
刻意爭取曝光；博取宣傳

Practice

1. The artist rarely **courts publicity**.
那名藝術家很少主動博取曝光。
-

DL. COURT POPULARITY

116. court popularity

= deliberately seek to become popular
討好大眾；爭取人氣

DM. COURT CONTROVERSY

117. court controversy

= behave in a way likely/intended to attract controversy
招惹／刻意引起爭議

Practice

1. The campaign seemed designed to **court controversy**.
那項宣傳似乎刻意引起爭議。
-

DN. COURT DANGER

118. court danger

= behave in a way that invites or increases the likelihood of danger
招致危險；自找危險

Practice

1. Ignoring the warning would be **courting danger**.
無視警告等於自找危險。

Major figurative verb use.

DO. COURT DISASTER

119. court disaster

= act in a way likely to cause disastrous consequences
招致災難；自找麻煩

Practice

1. Continuing without a backup would be **courting disaster**.
沒有備份仍繼續進行，簡直是在招致災難。

Very high-value expression.

DP. COURT TROUBLE

120. court trouble

= behave in a way likely to create trouble
自找麻煩; 招惹麻煩

Practice

1. He was **courting trouble** by ignoring the rules.
他無視規則，根本是在自找麻煩。
-

DQ. COURT FAILURE

121. court failure

= behave in a way that makes failure more likely
招致失敗

Less fixed than **court disaster**, but established.

DR. COURT DEATH

122. court death

Literary/dramatic:

= behave extremely recklessly, as if inviting death
自尋死路; 招致死亡

Practice

1. Entering the area without protection would be **courting death**.
沒有保護裝備便進入該區, 等同自尋死路。

Strong expression.

DS. COURT RISK

123. court risk

= deliberately or recklessly expose oneself to risk
招致風險; 冒險招禍

Less common than **court danger**.

DT. COURT SUCCESS? — CAUTION

Court normally means **actively seek** things such as:

- approval
- support
- customers
- attention

or **invite** negative outcomes such as:

- danger
- disaster
- trouble

It is not a general synonym for **seek** in every context.

DU. COURTING — PARTICIPIAL USE

124. courting

Can mean:

A. romantically pursuing someone

追求; 求愛

B. actively seeking favour/business

爭取; 招攬

C. inviting danger/trouble

招致; 自找

Examples:

courting a partner
求愛

courting investors
爭取投資者

courting disaster
招致災難

DV. COURTSHIP — FIGURATIVE BUSINESS USE

125. courtship

Figurative:

= period in which a company/person actively seeks another party's agreement, investment, partnership, acquisition, etc.

拉攏／洽談期；「求愛式」接觸

Practice

1. Months of corporate **courtship** eventually led to a deal.

數月的企業間拉攏與接洽最終促成交易。

Business metaphor.

DW. COURT = GOVERNING BODY — SPECIALIST

126. court

In certain institutions:

= formally named governing body or assembly

理事會；管治機構

Examples can occur in:

- universities
- chartered organizations
- historic corporations

This is institution-specific and much less common than legal **court**.

DX. UNIVERSITY COURT — GOVERNING BODY

127. university court

In some university systems, especially Scotland:

= senior governing body of a university
大學校務／管治機構

This is a specialist institutional meaning, not a courtroom.

DY. COURT OF DIRECTORS

128. Court of Directors

Historical/institutional title:

= governing board bearing **Court** in its formal name
董事會／管治委員會

Specialist and often part of a proper institutional title.

DZ. COURT CARD

129. court card

British card-game terminology:

= king, queen, or jack in a standard deck
人頭牌；宮廷牌

AmE often:

face card

Practice

1. A king is a **court card**.
K 是一張人頭牌。

Established BrE lexicalized compound.

EA. COURT DRESS

130. court dress

A. traditional formal clothing worn at a royal court

宮廷禮服

B. formal clothing prescribed for certain court/legal contexts

法庭禮服

Context determines royal vs judicial meaning.

EB. COURT UNIFORM

131. court uniform

Historical:

= prescribed ceremonial clothing for members/officials of a royal court

宮廷制服／禮服

EC. COURT CIRCULAR

132. Court Circular

British royal-context term:

= official record of certain royal engagements

王室活動官方紀錄

Specialized proper-name use.

ED. KEY GRAMMAR — COURT AS NOUN

133. in court

testify in court
在法庭作證

134. before the court

appear before the court
在法庭席前出現／出庭

135. to court

take a dispute to court
把爭議訴諸法院

136. out of court

settle out of court
庭外和解

137. at court

Historical royal use:

influential at court
在宮廷／朝廷中有影響力

This differs from modern legal **in court**.

EE. KEY GRAMMAR — COURT AS VERB

138. court + person

court someone
追求某人／拉攏某人

139. court + approval/support/business

court support
爭取支持

court customers
招攬顧客

140. court + negative outcome

court danger
招致危險

court disaster
招致災難

EF. COURT vs COURTROOM

141. court

Can mean:

- legal institution
- judges
- proceedings
- sometimes physical place

法院 ; 法庭

142. courtroom

Specifically:

= room where legal proceedings occur
法庭審訊室

So:

The court ruled against him.

cannot mean:

✗ 審訊房間裁定.....

Here **court** means the judicial authority.

EG. COURT vs COURTHOUSE

143. court

= legal institution/proceedings
法院／法庭

144. courthouse

= physical building
法院大樓

EH. COURT vs TRIBUNAL

145. court

= judicial institution forming part of a court system
法院

146. tribunal

= body established to adjudicate particular categories of disputes/issues; exact legal status varies
審裁處; 裁決機構

A tribunal is not automatically identical to an ordinary court.

EI. COURT vs JUDGE

147. judge

= individual judicial officer
法官

148. court

= institution/body or judicial authority as a whole
法院／法庭

Compare:

The judge entered the courtroom.
法官進入法庭。

The court issued an order.
法院頒布命令。

EJ. COURT vs JURY

149. jury

= group of people formally selected to determine specified factual questions/verdicts in systems using juries
陪審團

150. court

= broader judicial institution/proceedings
法院

A jury is not the court itself.

EK. COURT vs TRIAL

151. court

= institution/place/process
法院／法庭

152. trial

= formal process of deciding a particular case, especially after evidence and arguments
審訊; 審判

You can:

go to court

but:

stand trial / go on trial

when referring specifically to being tried.

EL. COURT vs HEARING

153. hearing

= session dealing with a particular application/question/stage
聆訊

154. trial

= fuller adjudicative process determining a case
審訊

The exact distinction depends on legal system and procedure.

EM. COURT vs CASE

155. court

= judicial forum/institution
法院

156. case

= particular legal dispute/prosecution being decided
案件

Compare:

The case is before the court.
案件正在法院審理。

EN. COURT vs LAW

157. law

= system/rules of law
法律

158. court

= institution that applies/interprets/adjudicates law
法院

They are closely related but not synonyms.

EO. COURT vs LEGAL ACTION

159. legal action

= formal use of legal procedures against another party
法律行動

160. court

= judicial institution in which many such actions proceed
法院

EP. COURT vs ARBITRATION

161. court proceedings

= dispute resolved through state judicial system
法院訴訟

162. arbitration

= dispute submitted to an arbitrator rather than ordinary court adjudication
仲裁

Important legal/business contrast.

EQ. COURT vs MEDIATION

163. mediation

= neutral facilitator helps parties attempt agreement
調解

164. court

= formal adjudication by judicial authority
法院審理

The passage's metaphor matters partly because a teacher may want restorative discussion rather than a miniature adversarial court.

ER. COURT vs COURTYARD

165. court

May occasionally mean an enclosed yard, but modern everyday use usually means:

- legal court
- royal court
- sports court

166. courtyard

= enclosed open area beside/between buildings
庭院

ES. COURT vs FIELD / PITCH — SPORTS

167. court

= playing area for sports such as tennis, basketball, badminton
球場

168. field

= larger open playing area for sports such as baseball/field sports
場地; 球場

169. pitch

Especially BrE:

= playing field for sports such as football/cricket
球場

English chooses the noun according to the sport.

ET. COURT vs TRACK

170. track

= marked route used for running/racing
跑道; 賽道

Not normally a **court**.

EU. COURT vs DATE — ROMANCE

171. court someone

= deliberately pursue a romantic relationship, traditionally seriously
追求某人

172. date someone

= have romantic meetings/relationship with someone
與某人約會／交往

Court is more formal, traditional, or marriage-oriented in many contexts.

EV. COURT vs WOO

173. woo

= try to gain someone's romantic affection; figuratively try to win support/business
追求；爭取

174. court

= very similar, but often slightly more formal
追求；拉攏

Compare:

woo customers
招攬顧客

court customers
爭取顧客

Both are common figuratively.

EW. COURT vs PURSUE — ROMANCE

175. pursue someone romantically

= actively seek a romantic relationship
追求某人

Court often has a more traditional/elegant tone.

EX. COURT vs FLIRT

176. flirt

= behave in a playfully romantic/sexually suggestive way, not necessarily seeking a serious relationship

調情

177. court

= actively seek affection/relationship, traditionally more seriously

求愛; 追求

Not equivalent.

EY. COURTSHIP vs DATING

178. courtship

= process of romantic pursuit, often traditional and associated with eventual marriage

求愛期; 戀愛追求

179. dating

= modern process/state of going on romantic dates

約會; 交往

Large overlap, different register/connotations.

EZ. COURT vs SEEK

180. seek

= very broad “try to obtain”
尋求

181. court

= actively try to attract favour, support, customers, publicity, etc.
爭取；拉攏；討好

You can:

court investors

but **court** is not a universal substitute for **seek**.

FA. COURT vs INVITE — NEGATIVE OUTCOME

182. court disaster

= behave in a way that makes disaster likely
招致災難

183. invite disaster

= essentially the same figurative idea
自找災難

Invite disaster is often slightly more common conversationally.

FB. COURT vs RISK

184. risk disaster

= expose oneself to the possibility of disaster
冒著發生災難的風險

185. court disaster

= behave so recklessly that one seems almost to invite it
自找災難; 招致災難

Court is more rhetorically forceful.

FC. COURT APPROVAL — TWO POSSIBLE PARSES

186. court approval — noun + noun

= approval given by a court
法院批准

Example:

The sale requires court approval.
這項出售需要法院批准。

187. court approval — verb + object

= actively seek approval
爭取認同

Example:

The project courted approval from critics.
專案試圖爭取評論界認同。

Grammar disambiguates the phrase.

FD. COURT ORDER — NOUN vs VERB POSSIBILITY

188. court order — compound noun

= order issued by a court
法院命令

Do not parse it as:

court + order

meaning “seek an order.”

The normal interpretation is a compound noun.

FE. COURT REPORTER — COMPOUND

189. court reporter

Can mean:

A. legal transcription professional

法庭速記員／記錄員

B. journalist covering court cases

法庭新聞記者

Context is essential.

FF. COURT INTERPRETER

190. court interpreter

= interpreter working in judicial proceedings
法庭傳譯員

FG. COURT CLERK

191. court clerk

= court official handling records/procedure/administration; role varies by jurisdiction
法庭書記員 ; 法院文員

FH. COURT BAILIFF

192. court bailiff

= court officer responsible for specified courtroom/security/enforcement duties, varying by system
法庭執達員／庭警等

Jurisdiction-specific.

FI. COURT SECURITY

193. court security

= security arrangements/personnel in courts/courthouses
法院保安

FJ. COURT DATE

194. court date

= scheduled date on which someone's matter is to be heard/appear in court
出庭日期; 開庭日期

Practice

1. His next **court date** is in October.
他下一個出庭日期在十月。
-

FK. DAY IN COURT

195. have one's day in court

A. literal

= have an opportunity to present one's case before a court
有機會在法庭陳述案件

B. figurative

= finally receive a fair opportunity to explain or defend oneself
終於有機會申辯／為自己說話

Practice

1. She wanted her **day in court**.
她希望有機會正式為自己申辯。

High-value idiom.

FL. SEE SOMEONE IN COURT

196. “I’ll see you in court.”

= threat/statement that one intends to take legal action
法庭上見 ; 我要告你

Common dramatic/conversational expression.

FM. THROW ONESELF ON THE MERCY OF THE COURT

197. throw oneself on the mercy of the court

Formal:

= ask the court for leniency
請求法庭從輕處理

Legal/dramatic expression.

FN. FRIEND OF THE COURT

198. friend of the court

= English rendering of **amicus curiae**, a person/organization allowed to provide information/argument to assist a court despite not being a main party
法庭之友

Specialist legal term.

FO. COURT OF RECORD

199. court of record

= court whose proceedings/acts are formally recorded and which has specified legal status in certain systems

紀錄法院

Specialist and jurisdiction-dependent.

FP. ECCLESIASTICAL COURT

200. ecclesiastical court

= religious/church court dealing with matters under ecclesiastical law

教會法庭; 宗教法庭

Historical/specialist.

FQ. INTERNATIONAL COURT

201. international court

= judicial body established under international law/treaty arrangements

國際法院／國際法庭

Generic category; specific institutions have proper names.

FR. COURT OF INQUIRY

202. court of inquiry

= formal body convened to investigate a matter, especially in some military/official systems

調查庭; 調查法庭

Specialist.

FS. KANGAROO COURT

203. kangaroo court

= unofficial or sham proceeding that pretends to be fair but lacks proper legal standards
私設公堂；不公正的假審判

Practice

1. The disciplinary meeting was criticized as a **kangaroo court**.
那次紀律會議被批評為一場不公正的假審判。

Important idiom, often figurative.

FT. COURT = JUDGMENT METAPHOR

The legal sense generates many figurative expressions involving:

- accusation
- evidence
- judgment
- verdict
- trial

Thus the passage's:

turn the classroom into a court

means:

convert an educational setting into an adversarial judgment/punishment setting

rather than simply:

put a judge's bench in the classroom.

FU. FAMILY SWEEP

204. court — legal institution

= body with authority to adjudicate cases

法院; 法庭

205. court — judicial authority

= judge(s)/court acting officially

法庭; 法院

206. court — physical place

= room/place where proceedings occur

法庭

207. court — royal household

= monarch and surrounding household/official circle

宮廷; 朝廷

208. court — sports area

= defined playing area

球場

209. court — enclosed yard

= enclosed open area

庭院

210. court — verb, romance

= pursue someone romantically

求愛; 追求

211. court — verb, favour/business

= actively seek approval, support, customers, etc.

拉攏; 爭取; 討好

212. court — verb, danger

= invite or make a negative outcome likely

招致; 自找

213. courtship — romance

= period/process of romantic pursuit

求愛; 戀愛追求

214. courtship — zoology

= mating-attraction behavior

求偶行為

215. courtier

= member/attendant of royal court

廷臣

216. courtly

= relating to court or refined/formal in manners

宮廷的; 彬彬有禮的

217. courtyard

= enclosed open yard

庭院

218. forecourt

= open area in front of a building

前庭; 前場

FV. SEMANTIC MAP

The major modern meanings of **COURT** divide into four large branches.

A. Judgment / law

Passage

turn the classroom into a court
→ 把課室變成像法庭般審判人的地方

Literal law

go to court
→ 上法院

court order
→ 法院命令

court ruling
→ 法院裁定

B. Royal household

royal court
→ 皇家宮廷

courtier
→ 廷臣

courtly manners
→ 宮廷式／彬彬有禮的舉止

C. Enclosed / defined space

Sport

tennis court
→ 網球場

Food

food court
→ 美食廣場

Architecture

courtyard
→ 庭院

The spatial idea is a bounded or enclosed area.

D. Verb — actively seek / invite

Romance

court someone
→ 追求某人

Approval

court support
→ 爭取支持

Business

court customers
→ 招攬顧客

Negative outcome

court disaster
→ 招致災難

The semantic logic is:

actively pursue something until it comes toward you

which can be desirable:

love, support, business

or undesirable:

danger, trouble, disaster.

FW. MASTER COMPARISON — MCQ-READY

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
court — passage	比喻：像法庭一樣正式指控、判斷、審問及懲處人的環境
court — legal institution	有法律權力審理及裁決案件的法院／法庭
court of law	正式審理法律案件的法院
the court — judges/judicial authority	作出裁定、命令等的法庭／司法機關
court — physical room/place	進行司法程序的法庭
courtroom	法院內實際進行聆訊／審判的房間
courthouse	設有法庭／法院辦公室的整座法院大樓
go to court	透過司法程序解決爭議；上法院
take someone to court	對某人提出法律訴訟；告上法庭
bring a case before the court	正式把案件提交法院裁決
appear in court	正式出庭
court case	正由／將由法院處理的訴訟案件
court hearing	法院就特定事項進行的正式聆訊

court proceedings	法院內進行的正式法律程序
court order	法院發出的具法律效力命令
court-ordered	由法院正式下令的
court ruling	法院對法律問題作出的裁定
court judgment	法院正式作出的判決／判詞
court decision	法院作出的決定
court action	透過法院採取的法律行動／訴訟
court costs	司法程序涉及的法庭／訴訟費用
court record	法院案件的正式紀錄
court system	一個司法管轄區內的法院體系
lower court	司法層級較低的法院
higher court	司法層級較高的法院
trial court	最初審理案件、聽取證據的法院
appellate court	審查下級法院裁決的上訴法院
court of appeal	審理上訴案件的法院
supreme/highest court	司法體系最高層級的法院
High Court	某些司法制度中的高等法院
district court	某些制度中服務特定地區的法院
circuit court	某些司法制度中的巡迴／區域法院
civil court	處理非刑事爭議的民事法院
criminal court	處理刑事案件的刑事法院
family court	處理家事法律案件的家事法庭

juvenile court	處理未成年人士案件的少年法庭
small claims court	用較簡化程序處理小額民事索償的法庭
magistrates' court	某些制度中的裁判法院／治安法院
Crown Court	英格蘭及威爾斯處理較嚴重刑事案件等的皇室法院
probate court	處理遺囑／遺產認證事務的法院
bankruptcy court	處理破產事務的法院
tax court	處理稅務爭議的專門法院／審裁機構
traffic court	處理交通違例的法庭
military court	依軍事法律處理案件的軍事法庭
court-martial — noun	軍事法庭／軍法審判
court-martial — verb	把軍人交軍事法庭審判
moot court	法律學生模擬正式訴訟辯論的模擬法庭
court-appointed	由法院正式委任的
out-of-court settlement	不由法院最終判決、而由雙方協議達成的庭外和解
settle out of court	以協議而非完整庭審解決爭議
contempt of court	妨礙／違抗法院權威而構成的藐視法庭
open court	向公眾公開進行的法庭程序
court of public opinion	比喻：由公眾／輿論對某人某事作評判的「輿論法庭」
royal court	君主及其家臣、侍從、顧問等構成的宮廷
court — royal circle	朝廷／宮廷及其社交、政治環境
court life	皇家宮廷中的生活
courtier	在皇家宮廷服務／活動的廷臣

courtly — royal	與宮廷有關的
courtly — manners	傳統上極有禮、優雅、講究禮節的
courtly love	中世紀文學中的宮廷愛情／騎士式愛情傳統
hold court — literal	君主舉行正式接見／朝會
hold court — figurative	成為群體中心、高談闊論並吸引眾人注意
pay court to someone	正式／舊式：向某人獻殷勤、求愛或討好
court — sports area	網球、籃球等運動使用的劃定球場
tennis court	網球場
basketball court	籃球場
badminton court	羽毛球場
volleyball court	排球場
squash court	壁球場
pickleball court	匹克球場
court sport	在劃定球場上進行的場地運動
on court	在球場上／比賽中
off court	場外／非比賽時
home court	球隊／球員的主場
home-court advantage	在自己主場比賽的主場優勢
full court	整個球場；全場
half court	半個球場；半場
full-court press — sport	籃球中的全場緊迫防守
full-court press — figurative	全面而強力的說服／推進攻勢

hard court	硬地球場
clay court	泥地網球場
grass court	草地網球場
court shoes — sports	為場地運動設計的球場運動鞋
court shoe — BrE	女裝正式淺口鞋; 美式常稱 pump
food court	多家食店共用座位區的美食廣場
court — courtyard sense	較少用: 由建築圍繞的庭院
courtyard	被建築／牆壁圍住或半圍住的庭院
forecourt	建築前方的開放區域／前庭
petrol-station forecourt	英式: 加油站油泵所在的前場
Court — street-name element	地址中可表示短街、盡頭路或院落式住宅區的名稱元素
court someone — romance	正式／傳統: 追求某人、向某人求愛
court — intransitive romance	傳統: 以結婚為方向交往／求愛
courtship — romantic	求愛、追求及發展戀愛關係的過程
courtship — animal	動物在交配前吸引伴侶的求偶行為
courtship display	動物用來吸引配偶的求偶展示
court someone's favour	努力討好／爭取某人的好感
court support	積極爭取支持
court customers/clients	努力招攬顧客／客戶
court investors	積極吸引／爭取投資者
court business	主動招攬生意
court attention	刻意吸引別人注意

court publicity	刻意爭取媒體／公眾曝光
court popularity	刻意討好大眾、爭取人氣
court controversy	刻意／不顧後果地招惹爭議
court danger	做出令危險更可能發生的事；自找危險
court disaster	做出極可能造成災難的事；招致災難
court trouble	自找麻煩／招惹麻煩
court death	文學／強烈語氣：極度冒險而自尋死路
courtship — business figurative	企業為爭取合作、投資或交易所進行的長期拉攏／接洽
court — governing body	某些機構正式名稱中指管治委員會／理事會
university court	某些大學制度中的高層管治機構
court card — BrE	標準撲克牌中的 K、Q、J；人頭牌
court dress	皇家宮廷禮服，或依語境指正式法庭服飾
court date	排定的出庭／開庭日期
have one's day in court — literal	有機會在法院正式陳述自己的案件
have one's day in court — figurative	終於得到公平申辯／說明自己的機會
kangaroo court	缺乏正當程序、結果不公的假審判／私設公堂
court reporter — legal	法庭逐字記錄／速記專業人員
court reporter — journalism	專門報道法庭案件的記者
court interpreter	法庭傳譯員
court clerk	處理法庭程序／紀錄行政工作的書記員
court approval — legal noun phrase	法院批准

FX. PASSAGE RECAP

“How could the teacher protect the victim without turning the classroom into a **court**?”

Here:

court

= a place or process in which people are formally accused, judged, and subjected to decisions or punishment

In the passage it is metaphorical.

Best Traditional Chinese:

- 法庭
- 審判場所
- contextually: 把課室變成像法庭般審問人的地方

Natural contextual translation:

老師怎樣才能保護受害者，同時又不把課室變成像法庭一樣審問和判斷學生的地方？

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

court

= a legal institution/place where cases are formally heard and judged; here used figuratively for an overly judgmental, trial-like classroom environment

法院；法庭；此處比喻「像法庭般審判人的環境」

The biggest learner branches are:

go to court

→ 上法院／訴諸法律

court order

→ 法院命令

courtroom

→ 法庭審訊室

but:

royal court

→ 皇家宮廷

tennis court

→ 網球場

food court

→ 美食廣場

courtyard

→ 庭院

And the verb is a major shift:

court someone romantically

→ 追求某人

court investors

→ 爭取／吸引投資者

court publicity

→ 刻意爭取曝光

court danger

→ 招致危險

court disaster

→ 自找／招致災難

A useful way to organize the word is:

COURT

1. **judgment** → 法院／法庭
2. **royal household** → 宮廷
3. **bounded space** → 球場、庭院、美食廣場
4. **active pursuit** → 求愛、拉攏、爭取
5. **inviting consequences** → 招致危險／災難

In the passage, the contrast is especially important. The writer is asking how a teacher can **protect a cyberbullying victim and address wrongdoing without turning an educational conversation into an adversarial trial**. So **court** contributes the idea of formal accusation, judgment, guilt, and punishment—not merely the physical idea of a courtroom.